ROYAL REVIVAL

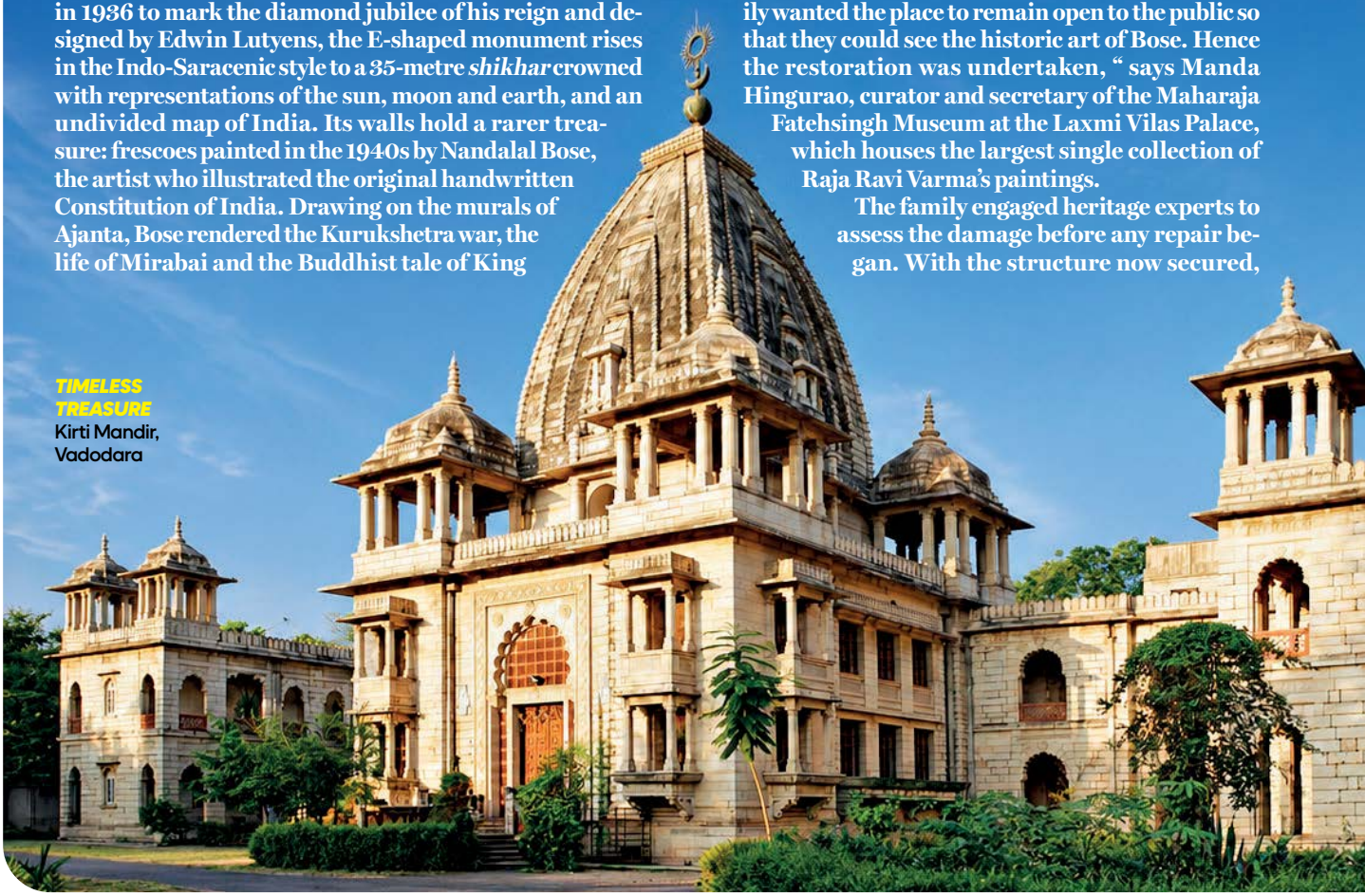
Kirti Mandir, the cenotaph of the Gaekwad dynasty that ruled Baroda for close to three centuries, sees its first major restoration

For the first time since it was built in 1936, Vadodara's Kirti Mandir has undergone a major restoration. Standing near the Vishwamitri River, about a kilometre from the city centre, Kirti Mandir is the cenotaph of the Gaekwads, the dynasty that ruled Baroda for close to three centuries.

Commissioned by Maharaja Sayajirao Gaekwad III in 1936 to mark the diamond jubilee of his reign and designed by Edwin Lutyens, the E-shaped monument rises in the Indo-Saracenic style to a 35-metre *shikhar* crowned with representations of the sun, moon and earth, and an undivided map of India. Its walls hold a rarer treasure: frescoes painted in the 1940s by Nandalal Bose, the artist who illustrated the original handwritten Constitution of India. Drawing on the murals of Ajanta, Bose rendered the Kurukshetra war, the life of Mirabai and the Buddhist tale of King Bimbisara across the main hall.

Time, however, had begun to tell. After floods in 2024, water seeped through the central dome and terrace, cracking the roof and threatening the frescoes below. The Bose frescoes had been restored in 2018 with help from INTACH, but the water seepage was threatening the structure. "The family wanted the place to remain open to the public so that they could see the historic art of Bose. Hence the restoration was undertaken, " says Manda Hingurao, curator and secretary of the Maharaja Fatehsingh Museum at the Laxmi Vilas Palace, which houses the largest single collection of Raja Ravi Varma's paintings.

The family engaged heritage experts to assess the damage before any repair began. With the structure now secured,



TIMELESS TREASURE
Kirti Mandir, Vadodara

ALAMY

EXHIBITION ▼

ART AND INHERITANCE

A multi-generational show of women artists at Vadehra Art Gallery underlines the need to shift away from the structures of patriarchy

What do women inherit from those who came before them, and what might they leave behind? At Vadehra Art Gallery in Delhi, *Women on the Edge of Time* brings together nine artists across generations and geographies to explore feminism, ecology, memory, resistance and inheritance.

Curated by Linsey Young, the exhibition takes its starting point from Marge Piercy's 1976 feminist novel *Woman on the Edge of Time*. Featuring Anju Dodiya, Arpita Singh, Ashfika Rahman, Gurminder Sikand, Jai Chuhan, Jasleen Kaur, Leela Mukherjee, Mumtaz Karimjee and Sheba Chhachhi, it spans painting, drawing, photography and installation.

For gallery director Roshini Vadehra, the title captures the urgency of the present. "It describes this particular moment we are living through—a moment where it feels increasingly clear that we need a shift away from the structures of patriarchy," she says.

